

To: (unknown), [REDACTED]
From: [REDACTED] INTERNET: [REDACTED]
Date: 8/9/98, 4:03 PM
Re: Ice shelf considerations

File
★ Global Warming
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[REDACTED]

To: [REDACTED]
From: [REDACTED]
Subject: Ice shelf considerations
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>ANTARCTIC ICE SHEET

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>According to CNN interactive at

><http://www.cnn.com/TECH/science/9807/24/science.glacier.reut/> a further
>melting of the ice in Antarctica has just been reported on July 24, 1998.

>This melting is more significant than the melting of Larsen's Ice Ledge
>(LIL) because LIL is on the northern most part of the continent, the most
>likely place to melt if the oceans are warming, whereas this new melting of
>the Pine Island glacier (PI) is in the middle of
>Antarctica. Is this not what happens when a pond begins to melt, in the
>middle first? It is melting from the bottom because, they believe, the
>oceans are 4.5 degrees warmer than normal presumably from the green house
>effect. This phenomenon is just now beginning to be understood.

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>According to CNN interactive, "A melting Antarctic glacier could lead to
>the collapse of the West Antarctic Ice Sheet (WAIS), causing global sea
>levels to rise up to 20 feet, researchers said Thursday."

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>This is 20 feet more!!!

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>If the entire Antarctic ice cap were to melt, the world's sea levels would
>rise about 60 meters. However, even 20 feet or about 6 meters would cause a
>world catastrophe, and if there is even the slim chance that this might
>happen, the world should know and begin to at least think about what to do
>if this happens. If the ice is melting in the
>Antarctic winter now, what will happen in 4 to 6 months as we approach the
>Antarctic summer?

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>And one last thing, "The total size of the Larsen B Ice shelf is more than
>all the previous ice that has been lost from Antarctic ice sheets in the
>past two decades." According to CNN interactive. This means that if Larsen
>B Ice shelf (LBIS) breaks off, (it is expected that about two thirds of
>LBIS will break off) more ice will go into the world's seas from that break
>than has in the last 13 or 14 years combined total. This appears to be a
>major warming. I reported that this LBIS would raise the world's oceans by
>65 feet. This is according to the Arizona Republic in Phoenix. We have
>checked this out mathematically based on the amount of ice relative to the
>surface area of the world's oceans, and it does not seem to compute, but
>perhaps those figures are based on the entire shelf melting, we are not
>sure. But do understand that whatever the sea rise will be with LBIS, it is

>added to the WAIS melt of 20 feet
>if it happens.

Regards


Web Administrator
CSETI
http://